HOUSING REFORM IMPACT BRIEF

WHAT THE 2026 ELECTION DID TO PENNSYLVANIA'S HOUSING VOTE MATH

November 4, 2026 · Build Philly Now · PA Housing Choices coalition analysis

PRELIMINARY — UNOFFICIAL RETURNS, SEVERAL RACES UNCALLED

STATEWIDE: A DEMOCRATIC TRIFECTA

Democrats expanded their state House majority and **flipped the state Senate for the first time since 1994**, while Gov. Shapiro won re-election. For housing reform, control of the Senate is the whole story: it is the chamber where House-passed zoning bills went to die.

~108 / 203

STATE HOUSE — DEMOCRATIC

Up from 103. Net ≈ **+5**. Six R→D flips called; 7 races still uncalled.

~26 / 50

STATE SENATE — DEMOCRATIC

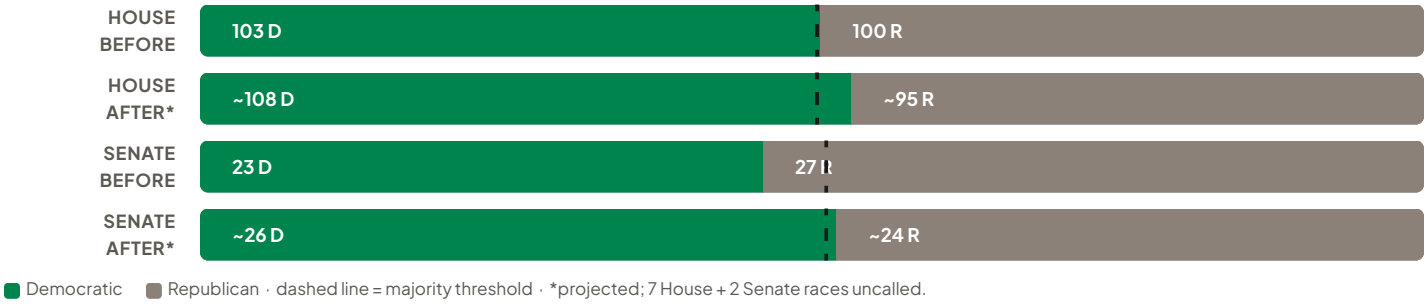
Up from 23 (was R 27–23). Net **+3**. First D majority in 30+ years.

3

BRANCHES ALIGNED

House + Senate + Governor. Bills can now move through **both** chambers.

CHAMBER CONTROL, BEFORE AND AFTER

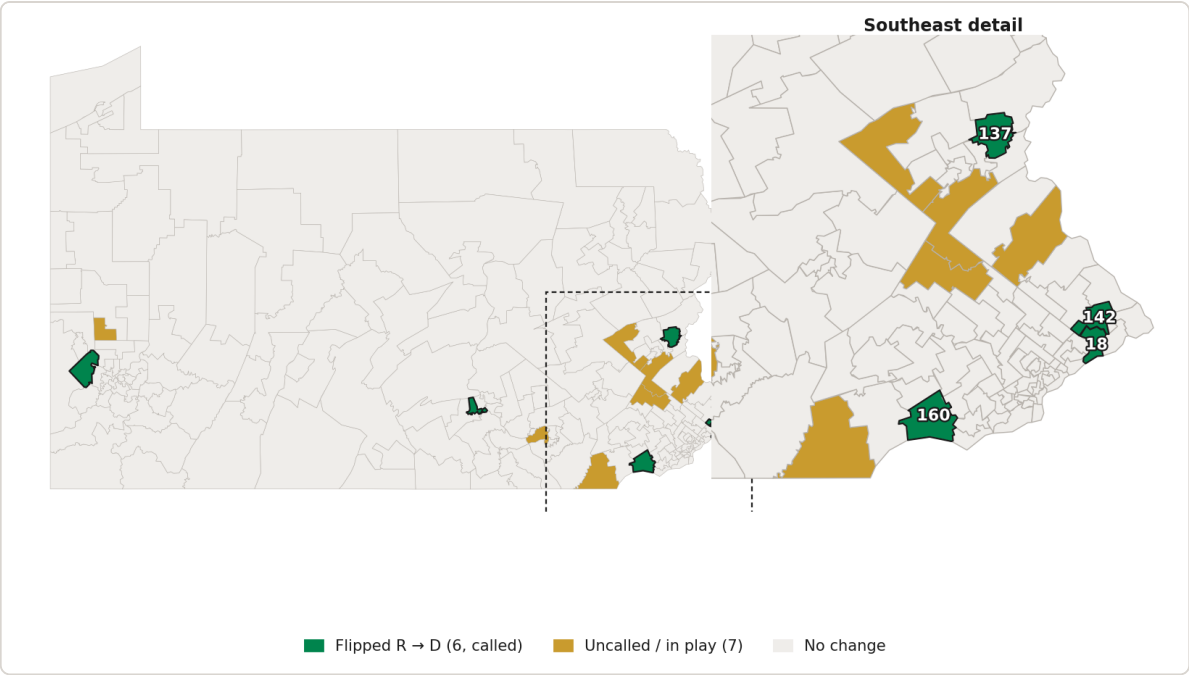


BOTTOM LINE

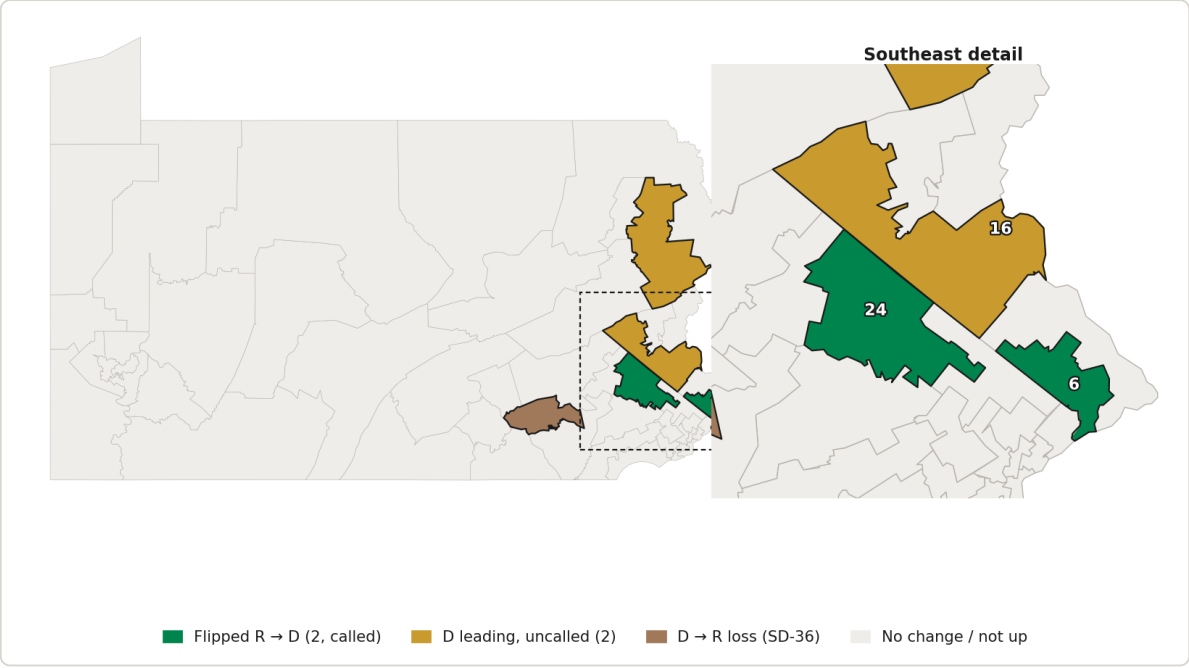
The House never killed these bills — HB 2186 passed 139–62 and HB 2109 passed 123–78. They died in a Republican Senate. A Democratic Senate, House, and Governor turns "passes the House, dies in the Senate" into a bill that can actually reach Shapiro's desk. The cost: the bipartisan Republican bench thinned — two of the reform coalition's most reliable Republicans lost (see p. 3).

WHERE THE SEATS CHANGED HANDS

Nearly every flip is in the **southeast suburban collar** — our softest, most-gettable Republican tier — plus the **Lehigh Valley**. The deep-red rural regions did not move. No opponents were converted; the gains came from suburban seats changing party outright.



STATE HOUSE — 6 FLIPS, ALL R→D. Bucks (HD-18, HD-142), Delaware/Chester (HD-160), Lehigh Valley/Northampton (HD-137), Harrisburg metro/Cumberland (HD-88, open seat), and Allegheny (HD-44). Amber = 7 uncalled races (including one Democratic seat, HD-12, that could still flip R).



STATE SENATE — THE CHAMBER FLIPS. SD-6 (Bucks) and SD-24 (Montgomery/Berks) called R→D; SD-16 (Lehigh/Bucks) and SD-40 (NEPA) Democratic-leading but uncalled. SD-36 (Lancaster) is the lone seat lost — a Democrat replaced by a Republican.

All figures unofficial as of the morning of Nov. 4, 2026. Seat counts are projections; 7 House and 2 Senate races remained uncalled and were still moving. Verify against certified PA Department of State returns before publishing.

HOW THE MEMBERS WHO LOST VOTED ON LAST YEAR'S HOUSING BILLS

Every House member who lost (or whose open seat flipped) was a Republican. Their records on the two 2026 House zoning bills — **HB 2186** (accessory dwelling units) and **HB 2109** (occupancy reform) — on final passage:

DISTRICT / REGION	MEMBER (LOST)	HB 2186 ADU	HB 2109 OCCUPANCY	STATUS
HD-142 Bucks	Joe Hogan	Yea	Yea	ANCHOR — YEA ON BOTH
HD-137 Lehigh Valley	Joe Emrick	Yea	Yea	ANCHOR — YEA ON BOTH
HD-44 Allegheny	Valerie Gaydos	Yea	Yea	YEA ON BOTH
HD-18 Bucks	K.C. Tomlinson	Nay	Yea	SPLIT
HD-88 Cumberland	Sheryl Delozier	Nay	Yea	RETIRED — OPEN SEAT
HD-160 Delaware/Chester	Craig Williams	Nay	Nay	NAY ON BOTH

Final-passage roll calls (HB 2186 rc 1075; HB 2109 rc 1119). Note: this differs from the June crosstab, which used HB 2109 2nd Consideration — Gaydos and Williams both moved between the two readings. Senators who lost do not appear here; they don't vote on House bills.

Read: three reliable reform Republicans were removed by voters — Hogan, Emrick, Gaydos (Yea on both). Williams was a No on both, so replacing him with a Democrat is a net gain. The raw Yea count holds or improves, but two of the coalition's rock-solid Republican champions (Hogan, Emrick) are gone.

IMPACT ON THE HOUSING & TRANSPORTATION COMMITTEES

COMMITTEE	OFF THE COMMITTEE — LOST (UNELECTED)	PENDING (UNCALLED, TRAILING)
Senate Urban Affairs & Housing	**Frank Farry** (SD-6, R) — defeated	Jarrett Coleman (SD-16, R) — a rare R cosponsor
House Housing & Community Dev.	**K.C. Tomlinson** (HD-18, R) — defeated	Milou Mackenzie (HD-131, R)
House Transportation	**K.C. Tomlinson** (HD-18, R) — defeated	Shelby Labs (HD-143), Donna Scheuren (HD-147)
Senate Local Government	none called	Rosemary Brown (SD-40, R)
Senate Transportation	none called	Rosemary Brown (SD-40, R)
House Local Government	none called	Brett Miller (HD-41, R)

Delozier (HD-88) also left, but by **retiring**, not losing — and she sat on none of these committees. Rosters are rebuilt next session; under Democratic control both chambers' committees get new Democratic chairs (next page).

NEW GAVELS: WHO CHAIRS THE HOUSING & TRANSPORTATION COMMITTEES

Because the **Senate** flipped, its current Democratic "minority chairs" take the gavel. The House was already Democratic, so those chairs are unchanged. The highest-leverage change for housing: **Nikil Saval** — a leading pro-housing voice — would chair Senate Urban Affairs & Housing, the committee that gated these bills.

SENATE URBAN AFFAIRS & HOUSING
from Joe Picozzi (R, SD-5)
▼ gavel to
Nikil Saval (D, SD-1)

SENATE LOCAL GOVERNMENT
from Dawn Keefer (R, SD-31)
▼ gavel to
Patty Kim (D, SD-15)

SENATE TRANSPORTATION
from Judy Ward (R, SD-30)
▼ gavel to
Marty Flynn (D, SD-22)

House chairs (unchanged, already Democratic): **Housing & Community Development** — Brandon Markosek (HD-25); **Local Government** — Bob Freeman (HD-136); **Transportation** — Ed Neilson (HD-174).

LIKELY SENATE DEMOCRATIC LEADERSHIP

ROLE (CURRENT MINORITY → MAJORITY)	SENATOR
Democratic Leader	**Jay Costa** (SD-43)
Whip	Tina Tartaglione (SD-2)
Caucus Chair	Maria Collett (SD-12)
Appropriations Chair	Vincent Hughes (SD-7)
Policy Chair	Nick Miller (SD-14)

Unresolved: the caucus has not held its organizational vote. Jay Costa, Democratic Leader since 2010, is the presumptive pick for **President Pro Tempore** or **Majority Leader**, but no reporting yet confirms who takes which post. Treat specific leadership claims as speculative until the caucus votes.

Current Republican holders being displaced: Kim Ward (President Pro Tempore) and Joe Pittman (Majority Leader).

WHAT TO WATCH

- **The 2 uncalled Senate races (SD-16, SD-40)** decide whether the Senate committee losses are one Republican (Farry) or three (Farry, Coleman, Brown) — and firm up the majority.
- **HD-12** (the one Democratic House seat that could still flip R) sets whether the House net is +5 or +4.
- **Re-target the Senate nesting map.** Our prior targets — Ward (SD-30), Langerholc (SD-35), Picozzi (SD-5) — all survived; the chamber turned on other seats, so targeting logic changes under Democratic control.

Sources (all unofficial): MultiState PA-2026 results; Spotlight PA; Philadelphia Inquirer live results; WHYY; Daily Voice; PublicSource; Ballotpedia/PoliticsPA. Committee rosters and leadership from pasenate.com / pahouse.com (2025–26 session). Vote records from PA House roll calls rc 1075 & rc 1119. Figures subject to change until counties certify.

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